Any of these matchers except raise_error can be negated by using not_to instead of using to.

RSpec allows you to compose matchers to express compound behavior, and most of these matchers have alternate forms that allow them to read better when composed. Composing matchers allows you to specify, for example, multiple array values in a single statement and get useful error messages.

Here is a contrived example:

```
expect(["cheese", "burger"]).to contain_exactly(
    a_string_matching(/ch/), a_string_matching(/urg/))
```

In this case a_string_matching is an alias for match, and the arguments to contain_exactly are themselves matchers that must match individual elements of the array to allow the entire compound matcher to pass.

Running the Test

Having written your first test, you'd probably like to execute it. Although RSpec provides Rake tasks for executing RSpec, I recommend using the rspec command directly to avoid the overhead of starting up Rake. If you use rspec with no arguments, then RSpec will run over the entire spec directory. You can also give RSpec an individual file, directory, or line to run. For details on those options, see Chapter 16, *Running Tests Faster and Running Faster Tests*, on page 319.

What Happens When the Test Is Run?

It fails. You haven't written any code yet.

That's Funny. What Really Happens—Internally?

When you run rspec with no arguments, RSpec loads every file in the spec directory. The following things happen (this process is slightly simplified for clarity):

1. Each file in the spec directory is loaded. Usually these files will contain just these specs, but sometimes you'll define setup, or extra helper methods or dummy classes that exist just to support the tests.

2. Each RSpec file typically requires the rails_helper.rb file. The rails_helper.rb file loads the Rails environment itself, as well as the spec_helper.rb, which contains non-Rails RSpec setup. In the default Rails configuration the .rspec file automatically loads spec_helper.rb; you could also change the .rspec file to automatically load rails_helper.rb.